

Avian Influenza Nigeria Systematic Review

Formal project status, evidence position, and completion roadmap

Purpose

This document records the formal workflow required to complete the review, distinguishes completed work from provisional or pending work, and sets out the controlled path from the current search/reconciliation stage to final reporting. It is a project-control document, not a substitute for the manuscript or the final PRISMA flow diagram.

Current position	Search and candidate-reconciliation stage. The evidence library is not yet locked for screening.
Formal gates	Gate A: operational snapshot recorded, but exact-string/source reconciliation remains open. Gate B: not passed. Gate C: not passed. Gates D onward: not started.
Evidence available	PubMed v3, Scopus, ScienceDirect, OpenAlex/Crossref supplement, and a separately dated SerpApi Google Scholar supplement. WoS and AJOL remain unresolved for the current snapshot.
What has not begun	Final deduplicated screening set, full-text eligibility, extraction, risk of bias, certainty assessment, SWiM synthesis, manuscript update, and final PRISMA/PRISMA-S audit.

Status key

COMPLETE	Formally recorded and supported by an identified project artifact or run-log entry.	IN PROGRESS	Work exists, but the gate or evidence set is not yet final.
PENDING	Requires a defined action before the next formal gate can pass.	BLOCKED / WAITING	Dependent on external access, approval, or a source response.

Controlling principle: protocol freeze -> search strings -> screening -> extraction pilot -> risk of bias -> SWiM synthesis -> reporting -> PRISMA / PRISMA-S / SWiM audit.

1. Formal workflow: completed, pending, and gate position

The sequence below is the authoritative project order. Screening must not start from the provisional queue until the search and canonical-reconciliation gate is closed.

Phase / gate	Required formal step	Completed / evidenced	Pending or blocker	Status
0 / Gate A	Freeze question, scope, framework, eligibility, outcomes, review roles, and reporting standard.	Question and scope locked: Nigeria AIV, 2006-2026; CoCoPop/PEO; PRISMA 2020, PRISMA-S, SWiM; no forced meta-analysis. Role design recorded: R1 primary, R2 independent 20% plus all-excludes recheck, R1 arbiter.	Reconcile the protocol endpoint with the dated 16 September operational snapshot and record the amendment boundary clearly.	IN PROGRESS
1 / Gate B	Freeze and execute database-specific search strings; preserve exact strings, dates, limits, exports, and exceptions.	PubMed v3 and manual Scopus/ScienceDirect searches recorded. OpenAlex/Crossref supplement recorded. SerpApi Scholar supplement recorded separately.	Exact-string/source reconciliation remains open. WoS has no query/export because documents are disabled pending subscription. AJOL automation returned 403. Direct Scholar returned 429.	PENDING
2 / Gate C	Create the canonical library; deduplicate; reconcile DOI, PMID, and title-year identities; lock the screening denominator.	Mechanical audit completed across 2,161 input rows and 1,869 canonical components; 174 cross-source components under DOI -> PMID -> normalized title-year rule. No identifier conflicts under that rule.	Stored overlap fields need remapping. The provisional upper-bound queue is not the final screening denominator. Current set must be frozen after source decisions and unresolved matches are adjudicated.	PENDING
3 / Gate D	Pilot title/abstract screening and calibrate inclusion/exclusion rules.	Preliminary title/abstract decisions exist for the PubMed v3 working set; these are not yet a locked, full multi-source screening set.	Apply the frozen rules to the canonical library; run R2 verification on the defined 20% sample and all exclusions; resolve disagreements before full screening.	NOT STARTED
4 / Gate E	Complete title/abstract screening and retrieve full texts.	No final multi-source screening denominator or final full-text set has been locked.	Screen all records; log reasons for exclusion at full text; preserve inaccessible or awaiting-classification records in the audit trail.	NOT STARTED
5 / Gate F	Pilot and complete structured data extraction.	Extraction has not begun. The planned extraction domains are defined conceptually in the project workflow.	Pilot the form on a small set; extract study design, setting, host, dates, sampling, positivity, subtype, clade, reassortment, phylogeny, geography, and surveillance context.	NOT STARTED
6 / Gate G	Assess risk of bias and certainty without score-summing.	No final RoB or certainty assessments have been completed.	Use JBI prevalence/cross-sectional/cohort tools plus the custom molecular checks; provide narrative certainty using prognosis-style logic and identify evidence gaps.	NOT STARTED
7 / Gate H	Synthesize evidence using SWiM; use meta-analysis only if the data justify it.	No synthesis has been performed.	Build study-level evidence tables; synthesize temporal, geographic, host, molecular, clade, and reassortment patterns; do not conflate subtype, clade, reassortant, and introduction.	NOT STARTED
8 / Gate I	Update the manuscript and in-document tables/appendices.	Source manuscript remains untouched; no final results have been inserted.	Update methods, PRISMA flow, results, evidence tables, limitations, discussion, and conclusions only after the library and synthesis are locked.	NOT STARTED
9 / Gate J	Complete PRISMA 2020, PRISMA-S, SWiM, reference, and reproducibility audit.	No final audit has been completed.	Check every checklist item, search appendix, flow count, citation, DOI, terminology distinction, and dated amendment before submission.	NOT STARTED

2. Search-source status and formal implications

Counts below are operational records, not a final deduplicated evidence count. The 16 September 2026 snapshot and the 17 September Google Scholar/API updates must remain separately dated.

Source	Date / method	Current evidence	Formal status	Required next action
PubMed / MEDLINE	16 Sep 2026; NLM E-utilities; v3	140 base records; 53 molecular subset. Working screening notes include 142 screened records when two v1-only items are counted.	RECORDED	Preserve the exact v3 strings and export provenance; carry eligible and excluded decisions into the final canonical library.
Scopus	16 Sep 2026; manual export	204 records in the manual import.	RECORDED	Validate the export metadata and reconcile against the canonical DOI/PMID/title-year identity table.
ScienceDirect	16 Sep 2026; manual export	25 displayed/exported records.	RECORDED	Retain the search wording, date, filters, and export; reconcile with the canonical library.
OpenAlex / Crossref	Supplement; raw files 41/42	1,744 canonical supplement records after local processing; 1,627 were novel versus the PubMed working set under the prior comparison.	SUPPLEMENT	Use only after identifier remapping; do not present this supplement as a replacement for a locked database search without a documented amendment.
Google Scholar via SerpApi	17 Sep 2026; dated update supplement	140 raw rows; 99 cross-query canonical groups; 49 matched the current library and 50 remain unmatched. Direct Scholar was rate-limited (429).	SUPPLEMENT	Complete executed-string/filter reconciliation and adjudicate the 50 unmatched groups before deciding whether to merge or retain as an update search.
Web of Science	17 Sep 2026; Clarivate portal / CLI attempt	No query, hit set, or export. Free Trial API subscription request is pending; portal view reached but Documents were disabled.	BLOCKED / WAITING	Wait for approval; if granted, run the frozen WoS string and preserve API version, key plan, date, request count, and export. If not granted, document the non-search transparently and use a pre-submission update.
AJOL	Manual/automation attempt	Automation returned 403; no validated hit set or export in the current snapshot.	BLOCKED / WAITING	Run a compliant manual search/export if access is available; otherwise record the failed access attempt and pre-submission update plan.

Interpretation rule

The review may proceed only after the project records one of two defensible decisions: (1) complete WoS/AJOL access and merge their results into the current search set, or (2) formally document the access limitation and treat them as a dated pre-submission update rather than silently implying that they were searched.

3. Evidence-library reconciliation: current numbers and controls

These figures describe the current audit state. They should not be copied into the PRISMA flow until the canonical library, screening denominator, and exclusion reasons are frozen.

Audit item	Current result	Meaning / control
Input rows audited	2,161 rows	PubMed 188 + supplement 1,744 + manual 229. This is an input total, not a unique-study total.
Canonical components	1,869	Sequential DOI -> PMID -> normalized title-year grouping. Use as a reconciliation estimate only until adjudication is complete.
Cross-source components	174	Components containing records from more than one source under the identity rule.
Identifier conflicts	None detected under the current rule	Still review title-year collisions and incomplete identifiers; absence of a conflict is not proof of perfect matching.
Supplement-to-PubMed matching	124 supplement records matched	113 by DOI and 11 by PMID; 117 stored true flags were present, but stored overlap fields require remapping.
Manual-to-PubMed matching	127 manual records matched	115 by DOI and 12 by title-year; stored true flags were zero, so stored overlap metadata is not trusted.
SerpApi Scholar update	140 rows -> 99 canonical groups	49 matched current library; 50 unmatched pending title/abstract review. No eligibility decisions changed.
Provisional queue	160 upper-bound items	Not final. Do not use for PRISMA counts or begin definitive screening from it until Gate C is passed.

Data-quality safeguards before screening

- Recompute source overlap from identifiers rather than trusting legacy overlap fields.
- Inspect title-year matches manually where DOI and PMID are absent or ambiguous.
- Keep Iran and other non-Nigeria records in the audit trail as exclusions; for example, PMID 27677611 is not Nigeria-specific.
- Do not infer eligibility from an AIV keyword alone; apply the Nigeria-specific eligibility anchor.
- Keep the dated SerpApi supplement separate until its executed query strings, filters, and merge decisions are documented.

4. Completion roadmap from the current position

The roadmap begins at canonical reconciliation and ends at a submission-ready manuscript. Each stage has an explicit output and a stop condition so that unresolved search access does not become an undocumented methodological assumption.

Order	Next controlled action	Required output	Exit condition
1	Close Gate B: reconcile exact strings, dates, filters, export provenance, and source exceptions; decide WoS/AJOL disposition.	Database search log and amendment note with all source statuses.	Every named source is either searched and exported or transparently recorded as inaccessible/pending.
2	Close Gate C: recompute canonical identity mapping and adjudicate ambiguous title-year matches, including the 50 unmatched Scholar groups.	Locked candidate library, deduplication log, and denominator memo.	One record-level identity and source-membership decision for every candidate.
3	Pilot title/abstract screening with frozen eligibility rules.	Calibration memo; pilot disagreements; final operational inclusion/exclusion rules.	R1/R2 agreement is acceptable and all rule changes are recorded before full screening.
4	Complete title/abstract screening and retrieve full texts.	Screening log and full-text inventory.	All candidates have a decision or an explicit awaiting-status; full-text exclusions have reasons.
5	Pilot extraction, then extract all included studies.	Study-level extraction table inside the manuscript workflow; versioned extraction decisions.	Pilot corrections are incorporated and every included study has complete or explicitly missing fields.
6	Complete RoB and narrative certainty assessment.	JBI/custom molecular assessments and evidence-gap narrative.	No score-sums; judgments are domain-based and traceable to study information.
7	Conduct SWiM synthesis and decide whether any quantitative pooling is defensible.	Evidence tables, structured narrative synthesis, and any justified quantitative summaries.	Synthesis matches data structure; subtype, clade, reassortant, and introduction are not conflated.
8	Update the single source manuscript and in-document appendices/tables.	Revised DOCX with methods, results, flow, tables, limitations, and discussion.	All claims trace to the locked library and extraction/RoB records.
9	Run final PRISMA 2020, PRISMA-S, SWiM, reference, DOI, and terminology audit.	Submission-ready manuscript and completed checklist evidence.	All checklist items pass; counts agree across text, tables, flow, and appendices.

Immediate next action

Complete the canonical reconciliation memo and the Gate B source-disposition decision before any definitive screening work. This is the project bottleneck and the next auditable deliverable.

5. Decision gates, risks, and governance controls

Gate	Pass criteria	Current result	Control if not passed
A - protocol / scope	Question, eligibility, dates, framework, roles, and reporting standard are frozen.	Operationally recorded; amendment boundary still needs one clean final note.	Do not change eligibility or start definitive screening without recording the amendment.
B - search completeness	Every planned source has an exact string, date, filter, export, and access outcome.	Not passed: WoS pending; AJOL 403; Scholar direct 429; SerpApi update needs reconciliation.	Document access limitation and dated update plan; no silent substitution of sources.
C - canonical library	All source records mapped, duplicates resolved, and screening denominator locked.	Not passed: overlap metadata remapping and provisional queue remain open.	No definitive PRISMA counts or full screening until the denominator memo is approved.
D - screening calibration	Pilot decisions stable; R2 verification and all-excludes recheck complete.	Not started for the final canonical library.	Freeze the rulebook before full screening; record disagreements and resolutions.
E-J - downstream	Full text, extraction, RoB, synthesis, manuscript, and audit are complete and internally consistent.	Not started.	Do not populate final results from provisional counts or unverified candidate decisions.

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Pending WoS approval	The planned source is not yet searched in the current snapshot and its Starter API subscription is pending.	Retain portal evidence; wait for approval within the project decision window; otherwise record transparent non-access and a pre-submission update.
AJOL access failure	A 403 means no validated AJOL result set exists in the current snapshot.	Use compliant manual access if available; otherwise preserve the failed-attempt record and avoid implying completion.
Search-date mismatch	The protocol endpoint and operational snapshot are not identical.	Keep the actual snapshot date; record the endpoint/amendment distinction in the methods and search appendix.
Legacy overlap fields	Stored flags do not consistently reproduce independent identity matching.	Recompute all overlaps from DOI, PMID, and normalized title-year identity; treat old flags as non-authoritative.
Premature screening	Screening a provisional queue can bias the final denominator and PRISMA flow.	Gate C must pass before definitive screening; preliminary decisions remain provisional.

6. Formal record and handoff checklist

The following artifacts are the evidence base for this status report. They should remain the controlling project record unless a later dated amendment supersedes them.

Artifact	Role in project control
Workbench/13_WORKFLOW_prospective.md	Protocol and prospective workflow; records the operational reviewer-role design.
Workbench/15_RUN_LOG.md	Dated run log, gate re-audit, search-source statuses, amendments, and current decisions.
Workbench/11_Phase1_search_rebuild_DRAFT.md	Draft search architecture and database-specific line structure; not yet the final reconciled search appendix.
Workbench/45_MANUAL_DB_CHECKLISTS.md	Frozen historical/manual checklist for Scopus, WoS, ScienceDirect, Scholar, and AJOL.
Workbench/46_DEDUP_COLLAPSED.json	Current supplement records used in the mechanical identity audit.
Workbench/47_MANUAL_IMPORT_candidates.json	Current Scopus/ScienceDirect manual import records used in the audit.
Workbench/49_NEXT_SESSION_HANDOFF.md	Next-session gates and safe continuation instructions.
Workbench/50_END_TO_END_WORKPLAN.md	End-to-end phase plan and current project-position summary.
Avian_review_paper_fellow.docx	Single manuscript source of truth; not yet updated with final search, screening, or synthesis results.

Next-session acceptance checklist

1. Confirm this status report against the latest run log and note any new external response from Clarivate or AJOL.
2. Produce the canonical reconciliation memo with record-level source membership and unresolved-match decisions.
3. Finalize the Gate B decision for WoS, AJOL, and the SerpApi Scholar supplement.
4. Approve or revise the screening denominator; only then begin the controlled screening phase.
5. Keep the manuscript unchanged until the canonical library and screening rules are formally locked.

Prepared status: 17 September 2026. This report deliberately separates completed evidence from provisional, pending, and blocked work so that the review can progress without overstating search completeness or study eligibility.